

Μένιππος ὁ Περγαμηνός

Menippus of Pergamon and the Periplus of the Black Sea

eul_aid: lzo

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Γεωγραφία [Geography](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Menippus of Pergamon was a Greek geographer who lived during the 1st century BCE. He is known for writing a detailed coastal survey, or periplus, of the Black Sea. His work focused on practical measurements of distances and descriptions of landmarks, which was typical of the Hellenistic tradition of geography aimed at aiding navigation and trade.

His only known work, the Periplus of the Outer Sea, is now lost. It survives only through references and fragments cited by later geographers, most notably Strabo. Strabo used Menippus's data as a reliable source for his own descriptions of the Black Sea region, which indicates that Menippus's survey was considered accurate and useful.

According to modern scholars, Menippus represents the empirical, technical side of ancient geography. His work contributed to the collective geographical knowledge of the Greco-Roman world, particularly for a commercially vital region. Beyond his professional activity and his association with the city of Pergamum, no further details of his life are recorded.

Works (1)

- Ἀποσπάσματα · [Periplus of the Two Pontic Seas](#) · 7 passages